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Course: ITAI-2372-Artificial Intel Applications

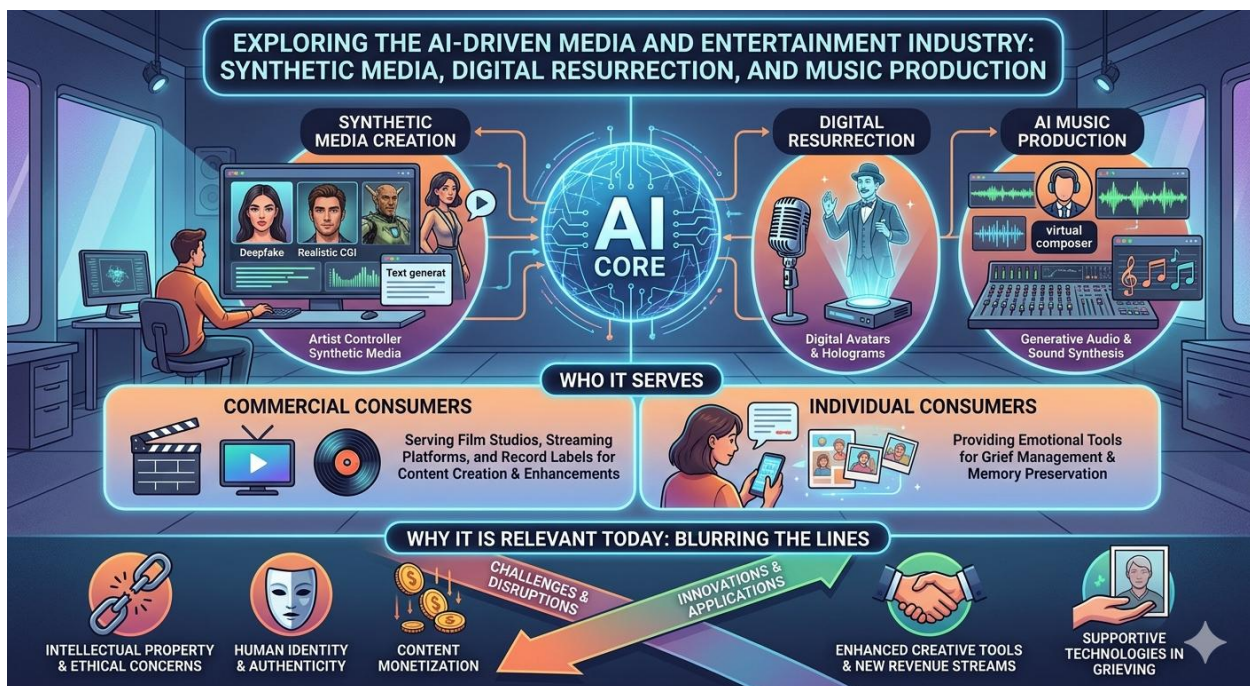
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A06 Entertainment and Media Module Reflections

1. Industry Overview

The industry chosen for this paper is the **AI Entertainment and Media Industry**.

- **What it does:** This industry uses smart computer programs (AI) to make music, videos, and digital clones of people.
- **Who it serves:** It serves movie studios, music companies, and normal people who want to remember their dead relatives.
- **Why it is relevant today:** AI can now make fake videos and voices that look and sound completely real. This changes how we make art and how we remember people.



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2. Current AI Trends

AI is actively being used in three main ways right now:

Trend 1: Fast and Cheap Music Making

- **Real Examples:** Apps like LANDR and iZotope.
- **Problems Solved:** Making professional music usually costs a lot of money and takes a long time. AI tools can mix audio files, clean up background noise, and fix sound levels in seconds. This cuts music production costs by 99%, helping independent musicians.

Trend 2: Digital Replicas of Dead Loved Ones ("Ghost Bots")

- **Real Examples:** An AI company in China called Silicon Intelligence.
- **Problems Solved:** Losing a family member is very painful. Some companies now use old photos and voice messages to create a digital version (avatar) of the person who died. Grieving people can text or video call these avatars to feel less lonely.

Trend 3: Bringing Back Dead Actors

- **Real Examples:** Deepfake technology used in Hollywood movies and music (like fixing John Lennon's old voice recordings for a new Beatles song).
- **Problems Solved:** If an actor dies before a movie is finished, studios can use AI to recreate their face and voice. This allows studios to finish movies without starting over or using expensive manual computer graphics.

Trend 4: Multi-Sensory AI Healing Environments (Example: DreamWeaver AI)

- **Real Example:** An open-source AI project called *DreamWeaver AI* (built with Unity, Arduino, and Meta Quest VR).
- **Problems Solved:** Traditional VR apps only look and sound real, but they do not feel real. When people are sad or missing their past, they need physical comfort. *DreamWeaver AI* solves this by connecting an AI Hypnotherapy Agent with physical hardware.
- **How it works:** The AI analyzes the user's voice and emotions. If the user is sad and talking about their childhood, the system automatically triggers physical hardware using an Arduino. It activates electronic Peltier plates to create physical warmth

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(like a warm hug or sunlight) and ultrasonic mist atomizers to release comforting smells (like a nostalgic memory).

- **Safety Feature:** The system also connects to an optical pulse sensor. If the user gets too emotional and their heart rate goes up, the AI automatically shifts the VR environment to a calming color or shuts down the hardware to keep the user safe.

(GitHub link: <https://github.com/binxixi23/DreamWeaver-AI>)

3. Ethical Implications

Using AI in entertainment creates two major ethical problems:

Concern 1: Using People's Likeness Without Consent

Dead actors and musicians cannot say "yes" or "no" to how their faces and voices are used. Movie studios or family members might use AI to make a dead actor appear in commercial advertisements or movies that the actor would hate when they were alive.

Concern 2: Trouble with Grieving

"Ghost bots" can help sad people feel better at first, but they can also cause mental health problems. If a person spends too much time talking to an AI version of their dead mother, they might never accept the truth. This can stop them from healing and moving on with their lives.

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4. Future Trends (5–10 Years)

In the next 5 to 10 years, AI will become a normal part of everyday media.

New Innovations

- **Custom Movies:** Movies and music will change automatically based on your mood or what you like.
- **Perfect Clones:** Digital humans will look 100% real and will be able to talk to you just like a real person.

Risks to Prepare For

- **Fake Media:** It will be very easy to create fake videos of politicians or celebrities saying things they never actually said.
- **Job Loss:** Real voice actors, background actors, and sound workers might lose their jobs because AI is cheaper and faster.

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Opportunities to Prepare For

- **Art for Everyone:** Normal people will be able to make high-quality movies and music from their home computers without needing millions of dollars.



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5. The Reflection

- **What surprised me most:** I was very surprised that making AI versions of dead relatives is already real business. It feels strange that companies are making money from people's sadness.
- **My Career Choice:** I would like to work in this industry, but not to make the technology. I would want to work on the legal and rule-making side. We need clear rules to protect people's identities and to make sure AI helps human creativity instead of replacing it.

References:

1. Forbes. (n.d.). Generative AI's Impact on Music. Forbes.
2. Larson, S. (2024). Deepfakes of your dead loved ones are a booming Chinese business. MIT Technology Review. <https://technologyreview.com>
3. Velasquez, S. J. (2023). How AI is bringing film stars back from the dead. BBC Future. <https://bbc.com>